that the old security state was no longer feasible. It is not an emotional position; it is just a fact of modern life. The game is up.

But what if I have it wrong? What if justice isn't really the most important goal and I overestimated its chances of ever being wholly achieved? Then we will have the pleasure, if only a small one, of knowing that week by week we helped achieve some modest goals for justice. We are not an ideology and we are not fastened to some kind of historical imperative: we are publishers who tried to respond honestly to what was happening. Part of setting up the organisation was to do with inspiring people – journalists, broadcasters, activists, readers, viewers, ordinary punters – to expect better behaviour from their institutions and from themselves. That little dream would stand behind everything we would set out to do.

But there's one guarantee in journalism: if you make it your business to point out a vast sickness, it won't be long before they're accusing you of being in the throes of some sickness yourself. I would come to say 'J'accuse', and, like all Dreyfusards, I would in quick time find myself characterised as a child-frightening weirdo with questionable hygiene and a horrible record in the treatment of colleagues and lovers. But that was all to come. As I left the University of Melbourne in 2006, it looked like the night sky and my own past gave a guide to how to proceed.

I had one or two certainties. Just one or two. They were to do with how we generated our history and our stories and our justice. George Orwell caught it best, when he wrote, in his novel *Nineteen Eighty-Four*, that he who controls the present controls the past, and he who controls the past controls the future. Orwell was talking about the power of governments to manipulate the people by propaganda, but, increasingly, I foresaw that by using our technology to understand why certain material was kept out of the public domain, and then devoting ourselves as publishers to making that material public, we could subvert the meaning of Orwell's words and turn them into a message of hope. Who would control the future? All of us. The digital era could begin to answer Orwell's point. The message, in fact, was the medium. And we were the messengers. The Net would work for the cause of revelation no matter what. And our job was to work as editors and context-makers, as well as protectors of sources. But could it actually work? Was there a way to make such a thing reliable and how could it be funded